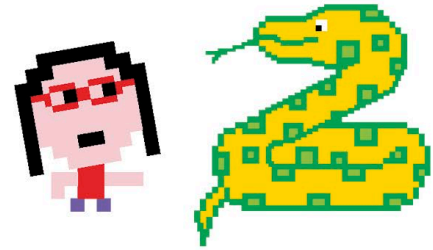


Using a module

To use a module in your code, you have to tell Python that you would like to include it. You instruct Python which modules to include using `import` statements. There are a few different ways that you can do this, depending on what you need from the module.



▷ `import...`

Typing the keyword `import` allows you to use all the contents of a module. However, you need to put the module's name before any function you use. This code imports all the `webbrowser` module and uses its `open()` function to open the Python website in the computer's browser.

```
>>> import webbrowser
>>> webbrowser.open('https://docs.python.org/3/library')
```

This line imports the whole `webbrowser` module.

The name of the module comes before the function.

▷ `from... import...`

If you only want to use a particular part of a module, you can import just that part by adding the `from` keyword. Now you can just use the function name on its own. This code imports the `random` module's `choice()` function. The function picks a random item from any list you give it.

```
>>> from random import choice
>>> direction = choice(['N', 'S', 'E', 'W'])
>>> print(direction)
```

Only the `choice` function is imported from the `random` module.

No module name is needed.

The code prints a random direction.

▷ `from... import... as...`

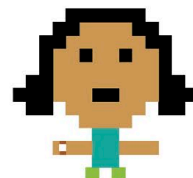
Sometimes you may want to change the name of an imported module or function, perhaps because you've already used that name or maybe it isn't clear enough. To do this, use the `as` keyword followed by the new name. In the example shown here, the `time()` function, which we've renamed `time_now()`, gives us the current time. The time given is the exact number of seconds since 00:00 on 1 January 1970 – a date used by most computers as the start of their clock.

```
>>> from time import time as time_now
>>> now = time_now()
>>> print(now)
1478092571.003539
```

This line imports and renames the `time()` function.

This variable uses the function's new name.

The number of seconds since 00:00 on 1 January 1970



You're exactly
1478092571.003539
seconds late!